

ANDREW AQUILINA

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Education

University of Pittsburgh
Ph.D. Information Science

Pittsburgh, PA
Aug 2024 – present

- Advisor: Prof. Yu-Ru Lin

Stockholm University
M.Sc. Computer and System Sciences, Artificial Intelligence

Stockholm, Sweden
Aug 2021 – June 2022

University of Malta
B.Sc. Information Technology, Artificial Intelligence

Msida, Malta
Oct 2018 – June 2021

Awards and Fellowships

Tertiary Education Scholarship	Government of Malta, \$60k	2024 – 2029
SCI Fellowship	University of Pittsburgh	2024 – 2025
Pathfinder Scholarship	Malta's Digital Innovation Authority, \$4k	2021 – 2022
First Class Honours	University of Malta	2021

Papers

* Equal contribution.

Aquilina, A., X. L. Li, and Y.-R. Lin (2027). "Whose Assessment of Distress? Community Perspectives and LLM Alignment on Well-Being Posts". In: *Proceedings of the 21st International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM 2027)*. **To appear.**

Aquilina, A., C. Nihalani, V. Varadarajan, N. S. Fishbein, Y.-R. Lin, and M. Sap (2026). "Lost in Delusion: Examining LLM Safety Under User Delusions and Distress". arXiv: [2606.00975](https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.00975).

Star, M.* , **A. Aquilina***, and Y.-R. Lin (2026). "Auditing Support Strategies in LLMs through Grounded Multi-Turn Social Simulation". In: *Proceedings of the SocialLLM Workshop at the 20th International AAAI Conference on Web and Social Media (ICWSM 2026)*. **Selected for oral presentation.**

Aquilina, A., S. Diacono, P. Papapetrou, and M. Movin (2023). An End-to-End Workflow Using Topic Segmentation and Text Summarisation Methods for Improved Podcast Comprehension. arXiv: [2307.13394](https://arxiv.org/abs/2307.13394).

Aquilina, A. and C. Abela (2022). "Predicting Links in a Social Network Based on Recognised Personalities". In: *Proceedings of the 37th ACM/SIGAPP Symposium on Applied Computing*. Virtual Event: Association for Computing Machinery.

Industry Positions

Loqus Business Intelligence
AI Engineer

San Gwann, Malta
Sep 2023 – July 2024

- Led new AI initiatives within the company, including the development of a customer-facing chatbot designed to answer questions related to deliveries.

Sambla Group
Data Scientist

Stockholm, Sweden
Nov 2022 – May 2023

- Leveraged NLP methods to cluster and summarise vast amounts of textual data to provide key insights for a cost-saving business strategy (30% cost reduction).

Ascent
Junior Data Scientist

Luqa, Malta
July 2021 – August 2022

- Contributed to the development of an item recommendation system in collaboration with a high-profile client in the beverage industry.

Junior Software Engineer

July 2019 – April 2020

- Assisted with the development of internal web and mobile applications using .NET technologies.

University of Malta
Junior Software Engineer

Msida, Malta
July 2020 – Sep 2020

- Developed an interactive game editor using OpenCV and Unity within the Department of Artificial Intelligence.

Teaching

Teaching Assistant

- Foundations of Artificial Intelligence, Big Ideas in Computing and Information (Fall 2025).
- Foundations of Cloud Computing for Data Science (Summer 2025).

Mentorship

- Katya Surendran, Pitt B.Sc. student (2026–)
- Michelle Star, Pitt B.Sc. student (2025–2026)
- Sean Jacobs, Pitt B.Sc. student (2025)
- Aishwarya Krishnamoorthy, Pitt B.Sc. student (2025)

Service

Reviewing

- ICWSM 2026
- NEJLT 2025
- GeBNLP 2025 Workshop at ACL 2025
- ICWSM 2025 (Posters, Demos, and Datasets Track)
- Pluralistic Alignment Workshop at NeurIPS 2024

Student Organisations

- Doctoral Guild, University of Pittsburgh — Officer (Spring 2025) → President (2025–2026).
- IAESTE, University of Malta — Officer (2020–2021).

Invited Panels

Panel on Responsible Technology

Organised by Tech For Good, University of Pittsburgh

Feb 2025